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Forget blackboards, chalk and textbooks... CD-ROMs are now *de rigueur* at Agamaa Virtual Classes

Preethi Chamikutty

The last time Snehal Gaikwad was interested in the past was when she watched a historical at the local cinema or on satellite television. Her latest screen, however, is something she will never forget—the white board at her coaching class.

This 15-year-old Standard X student of Mumbai's St Columbia High School actually is excited at

learning at her local coaching class. What made this happen?

Mumbai's Agamaa Coaching Classes, better known as Agamaa Virtual Classes, uses interactive CD-ROMs as a teaching tool, a move that has made students as excited as the teachers who teach the various subjects.

Snehal says, "I like history lectures the best because we see movie clips about various events. This helps me understand the event better and is easier to revise during exams."

Welcome to a whole new teaching paradigm!

Agamaa Virtual Classes is an offspring of Chetana Publications, a Mumbai-based publishing house that specialises in textbooks, and teaching guides. At the classes, however, students learn not by rote, but by associating images and sounds to the words they read in their textbooks and teaching guides. Chetana's already-existing database of computer books and related tools allows Agamaa to

